

Filling last-minute openings without the back-and-forth

When a client cancels, the gap only gets filled if someone at the front desk has time to chase it.

- 1 A cancellation leaves a gap in someone's chair.
- 2 You or Carla scan the Google Sheet for people who wanted an earlier time.
- 3 You text likely matches from the salon phone, sometimes several at once.
- 4 Replies, declines and who's been asked live in your head and the message thread.

"We've lost track of who was contacted and who declined, so chairs have stayed empty even when someone might have taken the time."

Lena

Texting several people at once can mean two of them say yes to the same appointment.

"Filled by the right eligible client without staff having to chase it or risk double-booking. Fast is helpful, but reliable movement matters more."

Lena, on what good looks like

One offer at a time, approved by you, moving on its own

1

Add the opening

Stylist, day, time and length, from your phone at the front desk.

2

The right person is lined up

Whoever joined the waitlist first, as long as their service fits the time, they can come then, and the stylist matches (or they have no preference).

3

You approve each text

You see exactly what they'll get. Nothing is sent until you tap Text, or you can skip someone.

4

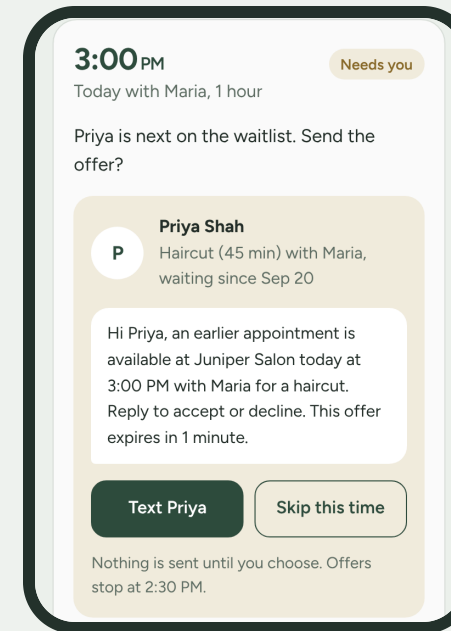
They have 15 minutes to reply

"Yes" books it, confirms by text and takes them off the waitlist. "No" or no answer moves to the next person, who's ready for your OK. No repeat follow-ups.

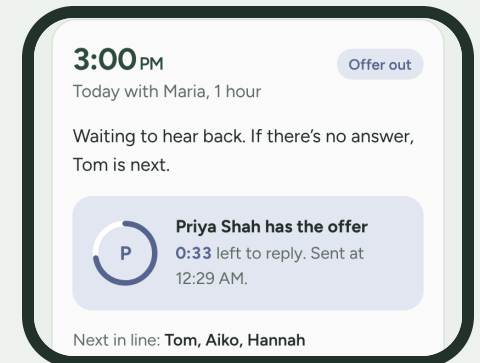
5

It stops when there isn't time

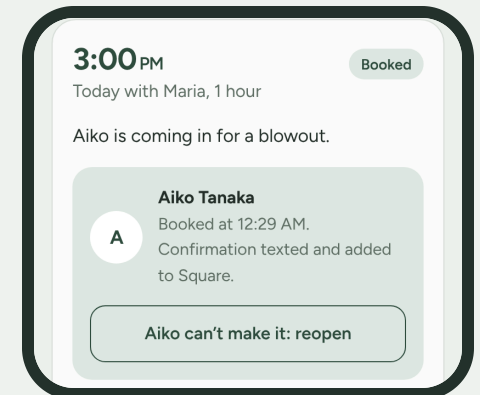
No offers in the last 30 minutes before the appointment. Every opening ends with a clear result: filled, or unfilled and why.



You approve the text



The countdown, and who's next



Booked and confirmed

When things don't go to plan, it still knows what to do

Each case below is handled in the prototype the way you described it.

A text doesn't go through

That client is marked "Can't text" and skipped, the offer moves to the next person, and you can fix the number later.

Someone says yes too late

They're told kindly that the time is gone, and they stay on the waitlist for the next one.

A walk-in needs the chair

Give the time to the walk-in. Any open offer is withdrawn and that client is told.

The booked client can't make it

Reopen the time and the next person in line is lined up, as long as there's still enough notice.

A no-show

Mark it after the start time. The opening is never offered to anyone after the appointment time has passed.

No one approves, or no one accepts

Nothing is sent without your OK. The opening ends as unfilled, and you can see exactly why.

Two people can't claim the same time, and a client never holds two offers at once, even when several openings come up together. Every offer, decline and timeout is recorded, and if the computer restarts mid-offer, it picks up exactly where it left off.

What's pretend in this prototype, and what isn't built yet

The decisions and timing are real. The connections to your phone, Sheet and Square are stand-ins so we could try it safely.

Simulated

Works in the demo, but doesn't touch real clients or systems.

- **Texts.** Offers and replies appear on on-screen "client phones." No real messages are sent.
- **Square.** Bookings and cancellations are recorded, but not written to your Square calendar.
- **The waitlist.** Seven sample clients stand in for your Google Sheet.
- **Practice mode.** A 45-second reply window so a demo doesn't take 15 minutes.

Not included yet

Left out on purpose to keep the first version simple.

- **Cutoffs by service.** Every opening uses 30 minutes for now. You said color may need more notice.
- **Adding people to the waitlist** from the app, and putting someone back on it after they cancel.
- **Staff sign-in**, so the history shows whether you or Carla approved each offer.
- **Free-form replies** like "can I come at 3:15 instead?" Clients reply yes or no for now.

Next step: a two-week pilot at the front desk

Connect the real pieces, keep your approval on every text, and see whether fewer chairs sit empty.

Before the pilot

Connect a salon texting number so clients can reply yes or no, read the waitlist from your Google Sheet, and add bookings to Square.

Weeks 1–2

You and Carla use it for every last-minute opening. You still approve each offer, so nothing goes out that you haven't seen.

End of week 2

A 30-minute review: what worked, what felt slow, and whether to keep approving every offer or let it continue after your first OK.

How we'll know it's working: openings filled, time from cancellation to booking, and how often staff had to step in by hand.

What I need from you

- 30 minutes to set the cutoff for each service (for example, more notice for color).
- Access to the waitlist Sheet and to Square for bookings.
- A yes on the wording of the offer, confirmation and "no longer available" texts.
- Who should be able to approve offers: you, Carla, or both.